

Gulf Coast Charters Network — 5-Year Business Plan

Mighty Organix · Alabama Gulf Coast · Sep 2026 · Printable summary (full detail in BUSINESS_PLAN_5YR.md + Excel model)

1. Executive summary

Premier multi-operator outdoor hub (fishing, adventures, watersports, yacht) with Zeke-inspired guest UX and owned Items/Resources/Channels + Stripe deposits — not FareHarbor-dependent, not an OTA discount brand. Sister: Gulf Coast Spearfishing.

Market context (sourced): Alabama's Beaches ~6.5M visitors / \$6.69B spend (2024) → ~7.14M / \$6.87B (2025); lodging ~\$923M (2025); ~70% lodging tax Apr–Sep.

Recommended model: Asset-light marketplace at ~12% Base take (+~1.5pts owned/sister → ~13.5% effective) on GMV via owned Stripe. OTAs only as capped Channels later.

2. Path to \$15k / month net profit (~\$180k / year)

This is a **scale target**, not a Year-1 promise. Base model hits ~\$15k/mo average around **Year 4** (~\$176k/yr point estimate).

- **Unit math (Base ASSUMPTION):** AOV \$750 × 13.5% take × (1–4% weather) ≈ **~\$97** platform revenue/booking; after Stripe/referral/SMS/blended CAC ≈ **~\$70–80** contribution.
- **Bookings needed for ~\$180k net:** roughly **3,400–4,000 completed trips/year** (~65–77/week average; more in Jun–Aug) at Base unit economics + ~\$100–120k OpEx.
- **GMV needed:** roughly **\$2.5M–\$3.0M / year** through GCCN at ~13.5% effective take.
- **Faster path:** raise AOV (private/yacht/spear mix) toward \$900–950 and/or own 1–2 high-margin SKUs — lowers booking count needed.
- **Seasonality:** average \$15k/mo means peak summer months may clear \$25–35k and winter \$3–8k — plan cash reserves.
- **Do not:** chase \$15k/mo in month 1 via OTA discounting — that destroys premier CX and margin.

3. Annual P&L; point estimates (pre-tax, ASSUMPTION-driven)

Year	Conservative	Base	Upside	Base ≈ \$/mo
Y1	~\$53k	~\$13k	~+\$39k	investment year
Y2	~\$54k	~+\$19k	~+\$130k	~\$1.6k/mo
Y3	~\$51k	~+\$77k	~+\$290k	~\$6.4k/mo
Y4	~\$43k	~+\$176k	~+\$566k	~\$14.7k/mo ← near goal
Y5	~\$26k	~+\$343k	~+\$1.04M	~\$28.6k/mo

Base Y1 sensitivity ~\$15k to +\$10k; Base Y5 ~+\$280k to +\$480k. Full engine: data/GCCN_5YR_Financial_Model.xlsx

4. What to execute to hit the \$15k/mo band

- **Y1:** Vercel+Stripe live; 8–15 curated operators; direct ≥70% GMV; SEO/GBP; no OTA-first; prove ~\$70+ contribution after CAC.
- **Supply:** Grow to ~25–40 quality boats by Y3–Y4 with live calendars (private offshore + sunset + watersports + spear sister).
- **Demand:** High-intent Google Search + Meta retargeting; marina/lodging QR (5–8% partner credit, not 25% OTA); review/itinerary SMS flywheel.
- **Mix:** Push private / celebration / spear AOV up; use jet ski/dolphin for awareness, not margin.
- **Ops leverage:** Founder-lean OpEx until contribution covers people; add CX/ops only when bookings sustain it.
- **Optional accelerator:** Own 1 premium sunset/yacht SKU for higher margin once demand is proven.

5. Milestones Y1–Y5 (short)

- Y1 — Live payments + tight roster + CX playbook + spear bar
- Y2 — 20–35 operators; Fort Morgan/Perdido depth; optional OTA Channel ≤15% GMV
- Y3 — Repeat engine; selective owned SKUs; white-label desk MVP explore
- Y4 — Corridor premier leadership; ~\$15k/mo Base trajectory
- Y5 — Durable P&L; Gulf expansion / franchise gate without discounting the brand

6. Key ASSUMPTIONS (edit in Excel)

- Base AOV \$750 · take 12%+1.5pts · Y1 bookings 900 · Y4 ~3,350 · Y5 ~5,200
- Paid CAC \$50 · Y1 paid mix 30% → Y5 18% · Stripe 2.9%+\$0.30 on fee slice
- Core OpEx Y1 ~\$62k + brand \$16k · founder-lean · pre-tax
- Tourism millions = context only — NOT GCCN capture rate

7. Risks

Weather/hurricanes · Apr–Sep seasonality · insurance/USCG · reputation · OTA dependency temptation · marina SEO competition. Mitigate with Green/Yellow/Red policy, cash reserve, credential checks, curated supply, owned Stripe.